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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION – OCTOBER 2026

FIFTH SEMESTER
MG5DSCMLM300 – GROWTH OF CINEMA

SCHEME FOR VALUATION

Part A – Short Answer

Answer any 5 questions; 2 marks each

1. Briefly explain how framing contributes to the visual style of a film. *[U] / [CO1]*

- Determines what is included in or excluded from the shot.
- Directs the viewer's attention to important subjects or details.
- Creates meaning through composition, distance, and angle.
- Can establish mood, relationships, and visual emphasis.

2. Explain the meaning of realism in Indian New Wave Cinema. *[U] / [CO4]*

- Represents everyday life and social realities with a sense of authenticity.
- Often focuses on ordinary people and marginalized communities.
- Addresses issues such as poverty, caste, gender, and inequality.
- Frequently uses naturalistic acting, locations, and restrained visual style.

3. Identify two Bollywood films dealing with social issues. *[K] / [CO3]*

- Accept any two relevant films, for example: Mother India (1957) and Taare Zameen Par (2007).
- Mother India explores poverty, rural hardship, and social responsibility.
- Taare Zameen Par addresses learning difficulties and the pressures faced by children.
- Other appropriate Bollywood examples may also be accepted.

4. What is meant by the term auteur in the context of French New Wave cinema? *[U] / [CO2]*

- An auteur is a filmmaker whose personal vision is evident in their films.
- The director is treated as a major creative force behind the film.
- Recurring themes, visual choices, and narrative approaches express the director's style.
- French New Wave directors such as François Truffaut and Jean-Luc Godard are commonly associated with auteur theory.

5. Name one Indian filmmaker who received international recognition at film festivals. *[K] / [CO4]*

- Accept any valid example, such as Satyajit Ray, Adoor Gopalakrishnan, or Mira Nair.
- Satyajit Ray received major international recognition for films including Pather Panchali.
- The answer should identify an Indian filmmaker known for recognition at international festivals.

6. What is a close-up used for in Classical Hollywood cinema? *[U] / [CO1]*

- Shows a character's face or a significant object in detail.
- Emphasizes emotions, reactions, or important narrative information.
- Guides the audience's attention to a particular detail.
- Supports continuity and emotional engagement within a scene.

7. What was the Production Code? *[K] / [CO2]*

- A set of censorship guidelines used by the American film industry.

- Also known as the Hays Code, it regulated content in Hollywood films.
- It restricted or discouraged depictions of sexuality, crime, violence, and other subjects.
- It strongly influenced Hollywood film content from the 1930s until its gradual replacement in the late 1960s.

[2 × 5 = 10]

Part B – One Paragraph Answer

Answer any 6 questions; 5 marks each

8. Analyse the development of the star system during the Golden Age. *[An] / [CO3]*

- The studio system developed and promoted actors as recognisable stars.
- Studios shaped star images through publicity, contracts, interviews, and carefully selected roles.
- Stars helped attract audiences and contributed to a film's commercial success.
- Genre roles and recurring screen personas made stars familiar to viewers.
- Fan magazines, posters, and other publicity strengthened their popularity.
- The system often limited actors' freedom to choose roles or control their public image.
- The star system linked celebrity, studio power, and audience identification.

9. Explain the importance of representation in contemporary Indian cinema. *[U] / [CO5]*

- Representation shapes how communities, identities, and social experiences are seen on screen.
- It can increase the visibility of groups historically underrepresented in mainstream cinema.
- Films can challenge stereotypes related to caste, class, gender, region, disability, and religion.
- Authentic representation can make stories more inclusive and relatable.
- Characters and narratives influence public understanding and social attitudes.
- Contemporary cinema includes diverse voices and perspectives, though gaps remain.
- Responsible representation requires attention to whose stories are told and how.

10. Discuss how genre conventions can be modified or combined to transform film form. *[U] / [CO1]*

- Genre conventions are familiar themes, characters, settings, and narrative patterns.
- Filmmakers can alter expected plot structures or character roles to create surprise.
- Combining genres can produce hybrid forms, such as comedy-drama or science-fiction thriller.
- Subverting conventions can challenge audience expectations and established meanings.
- Changes in cinematography, editing, sound, and performance can reshape genre style.
- Genre experimentation can reflect new cultural contexts and audience interests.
- Give a relevant film example to illustrate modification or genre blending.

11. Apply the idea of self-reflexivity to explain how a film can draw attention to its own construction and conventions. *[A] / [CO2]*

- Self-reflexivity occurs when a film makes viewers aware that they are watching a constructed work.
- It may reveal cameras, filmmaking processes, editing, or performance within the story.
- Characters may acknowledge the audience or comment on familiar film conventions.
- The film may interrupt conventional continuity or expose how its narrative is made.
- Such techniques encourage viewers to question realism and cinematic illusion.
- Self-reflexivity can create humour, criticism, or intellectual distance.
- Examples may include films about filmmaking or works that deliberately expose their own artifice.

12. Evaluate the role of Regional Cinema in challenging cultural stereotypes. *[E] / [CO3]*

- Regional cinema presents languages, customs, landscapes, and experiences beyond dominant mainstream narratives.

- It can offer locally grounded perspectives on caste, class, gender, and community life.
- Characters and settings may challenge simplified or stereotypical portrayals of regions.
- Stories rooted in local experience can broaden national understandings of Indian society.
- Regional filmmakers may experiment with language, form, and narrative style.
- However, regional films can also reproduce stereotypes or exclude certain voices.
- Overall, its value depends on the complexity and fairness of its representation; support with examples.

13. Describe the Lumière brothers and state their significance. *[K] / [CO1]*

- Auguste and Louis Lumière were French inventors and pioneers of early cinema.
- They developed the Cinématographe, which could function as a camera, printer, and projector.
- They organised public film screenings in Paris in December 1895.
- Their films often recorded brief scenes of everyday life.
- Workers Leaving the Lumière Factory and Arrival of a Train at La Ciotat are well-known examples.
- Their screenings helped establish cinema as a public entertainment and exhibition medium.
- Their work was important to the early development of documentary-style moving images.

14. Evaluate whether Parallel Cinema is necessarily realistic. *[E] / [CO3]*

- Parallel Cinema often addresses social realities and experiences overlooked by mainstream cinema.
- It frequently uses naturalistic acting, real locations, and understated storytelling.
- Many films examine poverty, caste, gender, rural life, and political structures.
- However, realism is a tendency rather than an absolute rule.
- Parallel Cinema can use symbolism, stylisation, allegory, non-linear narratives, or poetic imagery.
- Filmmakers may interpret reality rather than reproduce it exactly.
- Therefore, Parallel Cinema is often socially grounded but is not necessarily realistic in every film or technique.

15. Evaluate the use of AI in filmmaking. *[E] / [CO5]*

- AI can support script development, storyboarding, pre-visualisation, and production planning.
- It can assist with editing, subtitles, dubbing, visual effects, and restoration.
- AI tools may reduce time and costs for selected tasks.
- They raise concerns about authorship, originality, consent, copyright, and the use of training data.
- AI-generated likenesses or voices can create risks for performers and their livelihoods.
- Human judgement remains important for creative decisions, context, and ethical responsibility.
- Evaluation should balance creative and practical benefits against labour, legal, and ethical concerns.

[5 × 6 = 30]

Part C – Essay

Answer any 2 questions; 15 marks each

16. Examine how the introduction of synchronized sound changed film form and style. Discuss dialogue, sound effects, music, acting, editing, camera movement and staging. *[U] / [CO1]*

- Synchronized sound linked recorded voices and sounds to the images on screen.
- Dialogue became a major means of conveying character, information, and plot.
- Sound effects increased the sense of physical presence and helped construct believable environments.
- Music could accompany action, establish mood, and guide emotional responses.
- Acting styles changed as vocal expression, diction, and timing became important.
- Early sound recording often restricted camera movement because microphones and recording equipment were less flexible.

- Staging adapted to microphone placement and the need to capture clear dialogue.
- Editing practices changed as filmmakers coordinated image cuts with dialogue, music, and sound continuity.
- Some early sound films used longer takes and less mobile camera setups.
- Sound enabled new genres and performance traditions, including the dialogue-driven drama and the musical.
- Cinema developed techniques such as sound bridges, off-screen sound, and more complex sound-image relationships.
- The transition was gradual; filmmakers experimented with ways to integrate sound rather than simply record dialogue.
- Overall, synchronized sound transformed narrative, performance, technical practice, and cinematic style.

17. Examine how New Hollywood transformed traditional genre conventions. Discuss revisionist Westerns, crime films, road films and other genres in relation to changing American cultural contexts. *[A] / [CO2]*

- New Hollywood emerged mainly in the late 1960s and 1970s amid social and political change in the United States.
- Filmmakers challenged the polished storytelling and moral certainty associated with classical Hollywood.
- Antiheroes and morally ambiguous characters replaced many traditional heroic figures.
- Revisionist Westerns questioned the myth of the frontier and often presented violence and expansion critically.
- Crime films explored corruption, alienation, institutional failure, and the costs of power.
- Road films used journeys to explore freedom, rebellion, identity, and disillusionment.
- Other genres blended conventions or used unconventional narrative structures and endings.
- More explicit violence, sexuality, and social conflict reflected changing censorship and audience expectations.
- Location shooting, naturalistic performances, and experimental editing helped create a more immediate style.
- Films responded to the Vietnam War, civil rights struggles, counterculture, and distrust of authority.
- Examples may include Bonnie and Clyde, The Wild Bunch, Easy Rider, and Chinatown, with relevant explanation.
- Not every film rejected classical conventions; many combined innovation with familiar genre structures.
- New Hollywood renewed genres by making them more ambiguous, critical, and responsive to contemporary culture.

18. Evaluate the importance of Alam Ara in the transition from silent cinema to sound cinema. *[E] / [CO3]*

- Alam Ara was directed by Ardeshir Irani and released in 1931.
- It is widely recognised as India’s first full-length talkie.
- Its release marked a major turning point in Indian film production and exhibition.
- Dialogue became audible as part of the narrative rather than being conveyed only through intertitles or gestures.
- Songs and music became central features of Indian popular cinema.
- The film helped establish a model in which music, performance, and storytelling were closely connected.
- Actors and filmmakers had to adapt to new demands of voice, diction, recording, and sound staging.
- Production companies invested in sound recording equipment and new technical practices.
- Regional-language talkies followed, expanding sound cinema across India’s linguistic communities.
- The shift affected acting styles, scripts, studio practices, and audience expectations.

- Sound also brought challenges, including technical limitations and changes in the kinds of performances that could be recorded effectively.
- Alam Ara's historical significance is clear even though the film itself is now considered lost.
- It helped initiate the sound era in Indian cinema and shaped later popular film conventions.

19. Critically examine the relationship between technology and the changing aesthetics of Indian cinema. *[E] / [CO4]*

- Technological changes influence how Indian films are produced, distributed, and experienced.
- The arrival of synchronized sound transformed dialogue, music, performance, and narrative style.
- Colour processes expanded visual expression and changed the use of costume, setting, lighting, and spectacle.
- Improvements in cameras, lenses, lighting, and film stock broadened cinematographic possibilities.
- Portable equipment and location recording supported more naturalistic and independent filmmaking.
- Digital cinematography reduced some production barriers and enabled new visual styles.
- Computer-generated imagery and visual effects expanded the possibilities of spectacle and imagined worlds.
- Digital editing enabled faster workflows, complex structures, and precise control over rhythm and continuity.
- Streaming platforms and digital distribution changed access, viewing habits, and the circulation of regional and independent films.
- Mobile phones and affordable digital tools have opened new opportunities for emerging filmmakers.
- Technology can support experimentation but does not automatically produce artistic quality or originality.
- Access to expensive tools remains unequal, and technological dependence can affect labour and production practices.
- Indian cinema's aesthetics develop through the interaction of technology with culture, creative choices, audience expectations, and social context.

[15 × 2 = 30]